

■ **MAJOR SOFTWARE & OS UPDATES**

Apple iOS 26.4 update: What is new and how to download

Apple has released iOS 26.4, the fourth major iOS 26 update, bringing a mix of practical features and small enhancements rather than a major overhaul. The highlight is Playlist Playground, an AI-powered tool that creates playlists based on moods or situations, alongside a new Concerts feature that helps users discover nearby live shows and recommends artists based on listening habits. The update also adds offline music recognition through the Control Centre, allowing song identification without WiFi, and introduces an Ambient Music widget for quick access to curated playlists. Apple Music gets a visual upgrade with full-screen artwork for albums and playlists. Eight new emojis, the Reduce Bright Effects accessibility option, improved image tools in Freeform, and the ability to mark Reminders as urgent was also added. tinyurl.com/dc8hnex



■ **MICROSOFT AI UPDATES**

Microsoft takes a u-turn on bringing more AI features

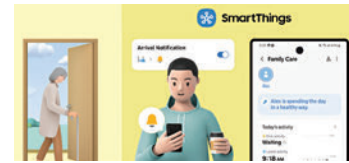
Microsoft appears to be rethinking its aggressive AI push in Windows 11, particularly around its Copilot assistant. After heavily promoting AI integration across



system features like notifications and settings, the company is now scaling back those plans. Reports suggest this shift comes in response to user

feedback, with many finding AI features unnecessary or intrusive, especially Copilot's constant presence (and that copilot button). Microsoft has acknowledged that it regularly tests features and may alter or remove them if they fail to deliver real value. As part of this change, the company has also scrapped its Copilot notifications feature, which was intended to let users interact with messages and perform tasks directly from notifications but never officially launched. Overall, Microsoft seems to be adopting a more cautious approach, focusing on where AI genuinely improves the user experience rather than forcing it into every aspect of Windows. tinyurl.com/d7det4

Samsung adds Family Care to SmartThings



Samsung has finally launched SmartThings Family Care in India, enabling remote monitoring of loved ones through connected appliances, activity tracking, and alerts, turning its smart home ecosystem into a safety and caregiving tool. tinyurl.com/mx89wqo

WhatsApp testing Guests Chats for iOS and Android users: What does it do



WhatsApp is testing Guest Chat, letting users message non-users via browser links. Guests can join without the app, though features are limited and chats expire after inactivity. tinyurl.com/f734hdcs

No more CAPTCHA? Reddit to soon offer a faster human check



Reddit is exploring biometric and passkey-based verification for human checks amid rising AI content, aiming to balance authenticity and privacy without revealing identities or compromising anonymous discussions. tinyurl.com/4hd723hx